Halloween Gnome

Acrylic Painting Guide

Materials: Preprinted 8 × 10 canvas • Acrylic paints • Large and small brushes
Water cup • Paper towels • Palette or paper plate
Paints: white, black, red, yellow, blue, green, brown

1. Prepare the canvas

Start with your printed 8 x 10 canvas. Protect your table. Use thin coats; rinse and blot brushes between colors.

2. Set the atmosphere

Mix blue, a speck of black and white for a smoky sky. Paint around every outline; leave the shapes white.

3. Ground & moonlight

Mix brown, a speck of black and a little white for ground. Use white + a little yellow for the moon; paint bats black.

4. Block in the plum

Mix red and blue with a touch of brown for plum. Paint the hat, brim and coat; keep the band and buckle white.

5. Add the autumn color

Mix yellow, a little red and a touch of brown for russet orange. Paint pumpkins and band, including buckle center. Leave faces and stems white.

6. Nose & leather shoes

For peach, mix white, a little yellow and a tiny touch of red. Paint the nose peach and shoes brown.

7. Shape the beard

Paint beard and mustache white. Mix white with a speck of black and brown for warm gray; pull curved strokes toward the tips.

8. Finish the base colors

Mix green with a touch of brown for stems. Mix yellow with a touch of brown for the buckle rim. Let dry.

9. Build depth

Mix red, blue, brown and a speck of black for hat shadows. Mix yellow, a little red and extra brown for pumpkin grooves. Blend softly.

10. Define the lanterns

Over dry paint, fill the pumpkins' printed eyes and mouths with black using a small brush. Keep the edges controlled.

11. Catch the light

Mix white with a little yellow for ivory. Add fine, curved highlights to the beard and small shine strokes to the shoes.

12. Dry & care for tools

Let your canvas dry lying flat. Wash and reshape brushes, wipe the palette and close your paint pots.

Thin coats • Let layers dry • Enjoy painting

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